
BONANZA CREEK
GOLD MINING & PANNING SIMULATOR
PLAYABLE NOW · STEAM EARLY ACCESS APRIL 2027



Every pan could be the big one.

Dig, pan, sell, upgrade. The ground is real









Every bite removes ground

Dig anywhere on a 65 × 65 m claim, 24 m deep today.

The gold is really there

It follows an old river channel you learn to read. No loot table.

It scales

Sluices wash, hired rigs dig, ore carts haul. 5 rigs and 3 carts in today's build.

Something to find every few minutes



Wall glints

A nugget in your very first cut, and more winking from pit walls.



The map tin

A torn claim map marks where a cache lies, 6–14 m away.



The buried cache

Dig where the map says and lift a strongbox of nuggets.



The deep pit

Keep digging: real ground, layer by layer, 24 m down.

Inspired by



Gold Mining Simulator

2017 · $19.99
15,172 reviews · 72%

Your own claim to mine



Hydroneer

2020 · $14.99
27,308 reviews · 85%

A camp built from nothing



Digging A Hole

2025 · $4.99
19,055 reviews · 89%

Digging can be the hook



PowerWash Simulator

EA 2021 · $24.99
51,100 reviews · 96%

Calm work done by hand

Steam store data, read 30–31 Oct 2026. Base US price, all-language reviews, % positive.

This shelf sells in the millions



2M+

copies, PC + consoles

Gold Mining Simulator
Code Horizon, Feb 2025



1M+

copies on Steam

Hydroneer
developer, 2026



1M+

copies in 4 months

Digging A Hole
publisher, Jun 2025

Copies sold, as announced by each developer or publisher.

Playable today

GENRE	First-person gold prospecting sim
IN THE BUILD	65 × 65 m claim, 24 m deep · sluices · 5 rigs · 3 ore carts
MODE	Single-player
PLATFORMS	Windows, macOS, Linux · Steam Deck by Early Access
ENGINE	Godot 4.7
PLAYTIME	4–6 h at Early Access · 15–20 h at 1.0 (targets)
HOUR 1 → 10	Shovel and pan → water monitors → rigs, rails, ore carts
PRICE	$14.99 (proposed)
BUILDS	bonanzacreek.lifewheel.us



Early Access April 2027, 1.0 November 2027

Oct 2026	Dec 2026	Feb 2027	Apr 2027	May 2027	Jul 2027	Nov 2027
Now	**Steam page**	**Next Fest**	**Early Access**	**The Creek**	**The Canyon**	**1.0**
Playable build	Store page live	Public demo	Excavator, The Mole	Second claim	Third claim	Neighbour claims
Home claim, 24 m deep	Trailer	Press and creators	Ground to 40 m	New river geology	Bedrock tools	1.0 trailer
Sluices, rigs, carts	Wishlists open		8 languages, Steam Deck			Creator keys
Self-funded	**$20k at signing**	**$15k**	**$25k**	**$13k**	**$13k**	**$7k**

One founder, contractors per milestone



Alex · founder, design and code

$550k
LifeWheel App Store sales, almost all organic

17 yrs
commercial software, 10+ as lead or senior

Playable
the full loop, today, on three platforms

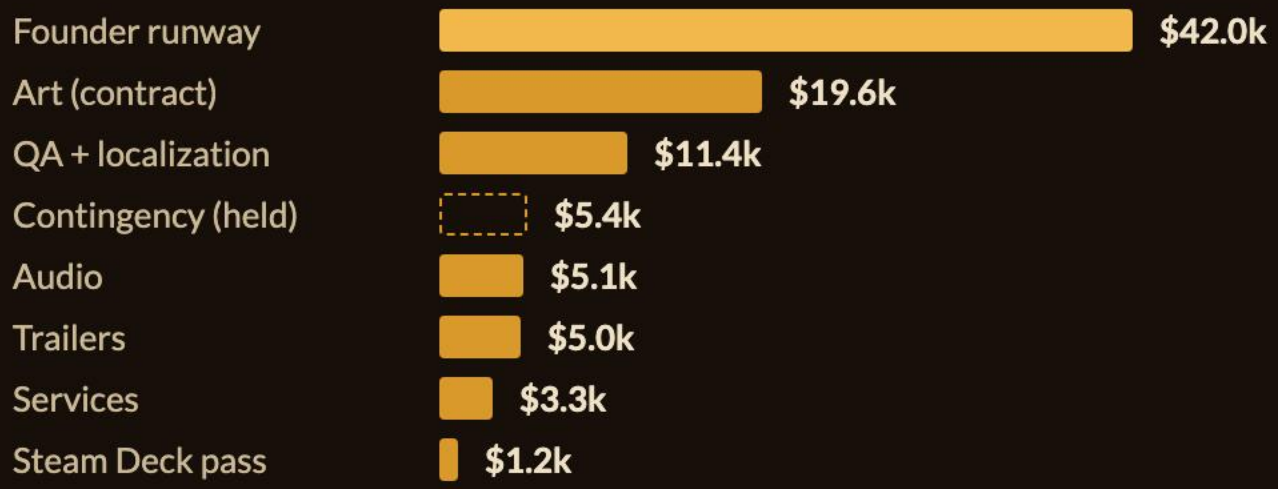
Why this game: of the 25 games I've built, this one drew the best engagement and feedback. It took off on itch.io before SIM Jam voting even began.

Contractors per milestone: 3D art, key art, music, QA, localization.

Paid in six milestones, signing to 1.0

$93,000

About $7.8k a month · PC build to 1.0 · excludes marketing and ports



Payment schedule

Dec 2026	Signing	$20k
Feb 2027	Next Fest demo	$15k
Apr 2027	Early Access build	$25k
May 2027	Creek claim	$13k
Jul 2027	Canyon claim	$13k
Nov 2027	1.0	$7k
TOTAL	each paid on a delivered build	$93k

From a partner: marketing, PR, events, console ports.

Contingency is held in cash from signing and drawn only against a named overrun.



Like Bonanza Creek?
Let's talk.

Alex · **alex@lifewheel.us**

Play: bonanzacreek.lifewheel.us

SCAN TO PLAY
PC builds and the gameplay video